

festival

Folk Lure

JAIPUR Think of Rajasthan and think of the state's rich folk music and dance. The city of Jaipur plays host to all this and more at the Rajasthan Day Celebrations starting March 24. The festival, organised by the state Government and Jaipur Virasat Foundation, gives a thrust to the state's cultural heritage even as it promotes its local artistes, ethnic art forms and crafts.

The festival opens with a Rajasthani dance performance at Amber Fort's Diwan-e-Aam. On day two, listen to dhrupad gayki by Pandit Laxman Bhatt Tailang, and his children Madhu Bhatt Tailang and Ravi Shanker Bhatt Tailang, at the Rasmanjari Sangeet Sansthan. Dhrupad is considered to be India's oldest classical form. On March 26, Australian music comes alive with a performance by Sirroco at the Amber Fort. Their instruments range from Middle-Eastern flutes to Irish drums and modern synthesisers. On day four, Nahid Siddiqui from Pakistan will give a

Kathak performance. Siddiqui's creations blend traditional with contemporary techniques and have been hailed as ground-breaking.

For those who like rhythm-oriented compositions, there is *taal kkachehri*—a percussion performance led by Pandit Bhawani Shanker. Also on view will be Inside Out, Outside, an art exhibition at the Museum Hall in Birla Auditorium. Artists and craftsmen from Rajasthan as well as from other states will display their work that combine the ideals of contemporary creative arts with urban regeneration that have led to the rejuvenation of artisan and crafts communities.

You can also be a part of the heritage walks, which will be organised daily through the old city. And don't miss the Gali Baazi performance on March 29. Gali Baazi is not a medium to insult society, people or organisations, as many think, but a home-grown style in which the performers speak and sing songs full of sarcasm, satire and humour. Soak yourself in some Rajasthani culture. On till March 30.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit

IN CONCERT: Members of the Australian band Sirroco



art exhibition

Memorable Encounters

MUMBAI The one thing you cannot miss about Nabibaksh Mansoori's artwork is his play of bright colours and the fractured reality that finds representation on his canvas. The images of an idyllic childhood meet with those of the post-technological era, and the dominance of blue in his work is truly fascinating. Characterised by wild imagination, tame creatures, real memories and surreal images, Mansoori engages with his favourite protagonist Krishna, who, despite his status as God, had to surrender his play in Vrindavan for moments of ploy in the battle of Kurukshetra. Mansoori's canvas is an amalgamation of images—a busy place, teeming with people, their dreams and memories—but more significantly, it is a place where animals, humans and objects pivot around his creative style. At Gallery Art & Soul. Till March 31.

by Swati Mathur

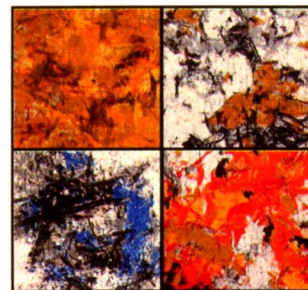
CREATIVE PIVOT: Mansoori's work, Ek Machhar



art

Assorted Montage

AHMEDABAD Ajay Chaudhary in his latest work draws inspiration from the New York School of abstract painting but he steers clear of any obvious derivation. The collection is a potpourri of images on the road like defaced advertisements on buses and hoardings. He reduces his abstracts to minimal palette of colour, stress-



Chaudhary's work ing on white and black hatchings, lines, erasures and scrapings on the canvas. At Marvel Art Gallery. Till March 31.

by Uday Mahurkar